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AI



Google rolls out AI-powered business-calling feature, brings Gemini 2.5 Pro to AI Mode

Google is rolling out an agentic AI-powered business-calling feature to all users in the United States, the company announced on Wednesday. The tech giant is also enhancing Google Search's AI Mode by bringing its Gemini 2.5 Pro model to the search experience and introducing deep research capabilities.

The new business-calling feature uses AI to call local businesses on your behalf to collect information about availability and pricing. The idea behind the feature is to help you access information without having to actually pick up the phone and talk to someone.

IMAGE CREDITS:
[MATTHIAS BALK/PICTURE ALLIANCE](#)
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Google began [testing the feature](#) back in January with users who opted into the company's [Search Labs](#) experiments.

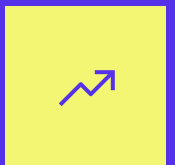
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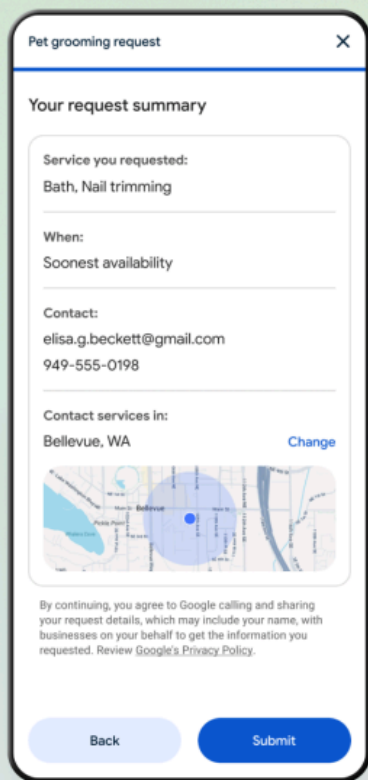
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To get started, you need to search for something like “pet groomers near me,” and you’ll see a new option in the results to “Have AI check pricing.” From there, you answer a couple of questions to receive information about appointments and services from different local businesses. For example, you will be asked which type of pet you have, which services you need, and when you need the service.

A Google spokesperson told TechCrunch in an email that every call to a business begins by announcing that it’s an automated system calling from Google on behalf of a user.

It’s worth noting that Google faced backlash a few years ago for a similar business-calling feature that simulated human speech, as some users were concerned that the company was misleading people into thinking they were speaking with another human. Following the backlash, Google said its AI would identify itself as a robot when placing these calls.

The new business-calling feature is starting to roll out to all Search users in the United States, with higher limits for Google AI Pro and AI Ultra subscribers.



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Google is also supercharging AI Mode, the Google Search feature that lets you ask complex and multi-part questions via an AI interface, with Gemini 2.5 Pro for Google AI Pro and AI Ultra subscribers. The tech giant says the model excels at advanced reasoning, math, and coding questions. Subscribers will be able to select the 2.5 Pro model from a drop-down menu in AI Mode.

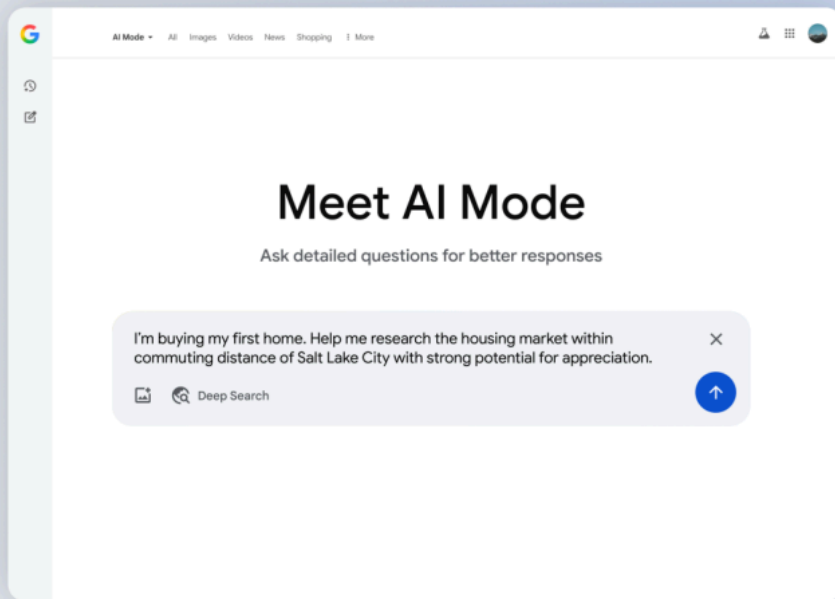


IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

As for the new “Deep Search” feature in AI Mode, Google says it will save subscribers hours by conducting hundreds of searches and issuing reasoning across differing pieces of information to create a comprehensive and fully cited report in minutes.

Google notes that Deep Search is useful for in-depth research related to jobs, hobbies, or studies. The company says it’s also useful in instances where you’re making big life decisions, like buying a new house or seeking assistance with a financial analysis.

Since its launch earlier this year, Google has been building out AI Mode with additional capabilities as it continues to take on popular services like Perplexity AI and OpenAI’s ChatGPT Search. For example, Google last month rolled out the ability to have a [back-and-forth voice conversation](#) with AI Mode. In May, Google introduced [a shopping experience](#) in AI Mode to allow you to view product

visuals and other AI-powered guidance that leverages product data.

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Google Search's new 'AI Mode' lets users ask complex, multi-part questions

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Google is launching a new “AI Mode” experimental feature in Search that looks to take on popular services like Perplexity AI and OpenAI’s ChatGPT search. The tech giant announced on Wednesday that the new mode is designed to allow users to ask complex, multi-part questions and follow-ups to dig deeper on a topic directly within Google Search.

How Déjà Vu Relates to Memory

AI Mode is rolling out to Google One AI Premium subscribers starting this week and is accessible via [Search Labs](#), Google’s experimental arm.

The feature uses a custom version of [Gemini 2.0](#) and is particularly helpful for questions that need further exploration and comparisons thanks to advanced reasoning, thinking, and multimodal capabilities.

IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE

For instance, you could ask: “What’s the difference in sleep tracking features between a smart ring, smartwatch, and tracking mat?”

AI Mode can then give you a detailed comparison of what each product offers, along with links to articles that it’s pulling the information from. You could then ask a follow-up question, such as: “What happens to your heart rate during deep sleep?” to continue your search.

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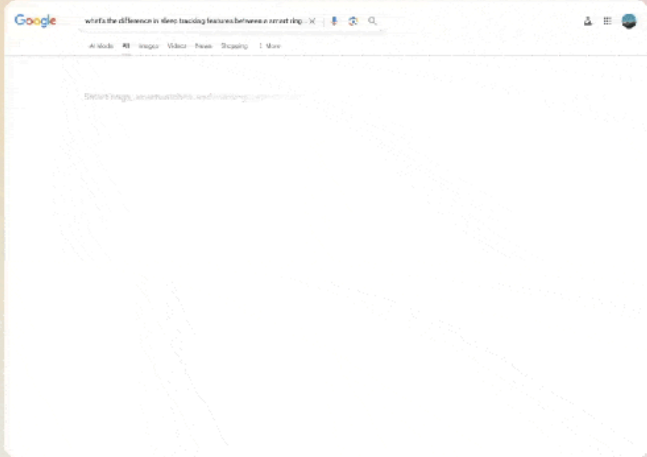


IMAGE CREDITS :GOOGLE

Google says that in the past, it would have taken multiple queries to compare detailed options or explore a new concept through traditional searches.

With AI Mode, you can access web content but also tap into real-time sources like the Knowledge Graph, info about the real world, and shopping data for billions of products.

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“What we’re seeing in testing is people are asking questions that are about twice the query length of traditional search, and they’re also following up and asking follow up questions about a quarter of the time,” Robby Stein, VP of Product at Google Search, told TechCrunch in an interview. “And so they’re really getting at these maybe harder questions, ones that need more back and forth, and we think, it creates an expanded opportunity to do more with Google search, and that’s what we’re really excited about.”

Stein noted that as Google has rolled out [AI Overviews](#), a feature that displays a snapshot of information at the top of the results page, it has heard that users want a way to get these sorts of AI-powered answers for even more of their searches, which is why the company is introducing AI Mode.

AI Mode works by using a “query fan-out” technique that issues multiple related searches concurrently across multiple data sources to then bring those results together in an easy-to-understand response.

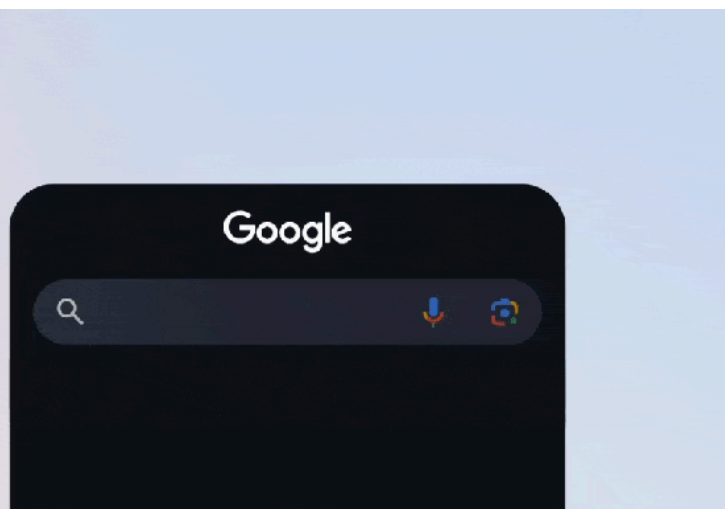


IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

“The model has learned to really prioritize factuality and backing up what it says through information that can be verified, and that’s really important, and it pays extra attention to really sensitive areas,” Stein said. “So this might be health, as an example, and where it’s not confident, it actually might just

respond with a list of web links and web URLs, because that's most helpful in the moment. It's going to do its best and just be most helpful given the context of the information available and how confident it can be in the reply. This does not mean it will never make mistakes. It is very likely that it will make mistakes, as with every new kind of new and cutting edge AI technology that's released."

Since this is an early experiment, Google notes that it will continue to refine the user experience and expand functionality. For instance, the company plans to make the experience more visual and also surface information from a range of different sources, such as user-generated content. Google is teaching the model to determine when to add a hyperlink in a response (e.g. booking tickets) or when to prioritize image or video (e.g. how-to queries).

Google One AI Premium subscribers can access AI Mode by opting into Search Labs and then entering a question in the Search bar and tapping the "AI Mode" tab. Or, they can navigate directly to google.com/aimode to access the feature. On mobile, they can open the Google app and tap the "AI Mode" icon below the Search bar on the home screen.

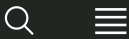
As part of today's announcement, Google also shared that it's launched Gemini 2.0 for AI Overviews in the U.S. The company says AI Overviews will now be able to help with harder questions, starting with coding, advanced math, and multimodal queries. Plus, Google announced that users no longer need to sign in to access AI Overviews, and the feature is now being rolled out to teen users as well.

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AI



Google’s AI Mode can now have back-and-forth voice conversations

Aisha Malik — 9:00 AM PDT · June 18, 2025

Google is rolling out the ability for users to have a back-and-forth voice conversation with AI Mode, its experimental Search [feature](#) that lets users ask complex, multi-part questions. With the new [Search Live](#) integration, users can have a free-flowing voice conversation with Search and explore links from across the web.

Users will be able to access the feature by opening the Google app and tapping the new “Live” icon to ask their question aloud. They will then hear an AI-generated audio response, and they can follow up with another question.

Today’s announcement comes a few weeks after [Google rolled out AI Mode](#) to everyone in the U.S. The launch of the feature was seen as Google’s answer to popular services like Perplexity AI and OpenAI’s ChatGPT Search. With this new update, Google is looking to take on those services’ respective voice modes.

Google says the feature will be useful in instances where you’re on the go or multitasking. For example, if you’re packing for a trip, you can ask a question like “What are some tips for preventing a linen dress from wrinkling in a suitcase?” You could follow up with another question like “What should I do if it still wrinkles?”

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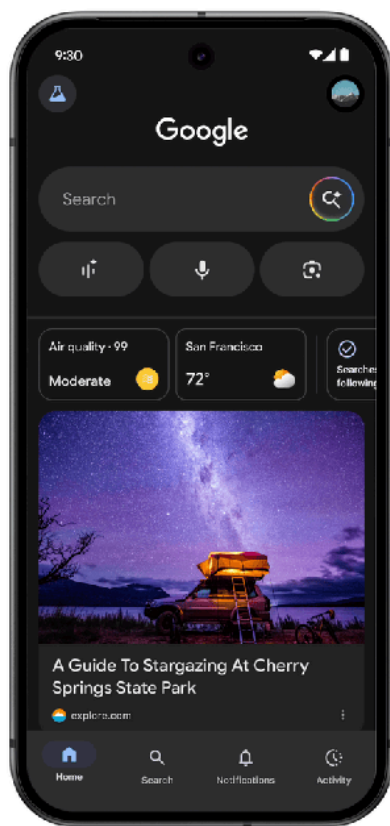
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Google takes on ChatGPT’s Study Mode with new ‘Guided Learning’ tool in Gemini

Aisha Malik - 14 hours ago



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IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

As you're having the conversation, you'll find links right on your screen if you want to dig deeper into your search.

Because Search Live works in the background, you can continue the conversation while in another app. Plus, you have the option to tap the “transcript” button to view the text response and continue to ask questions by typing if you'd like to. You can also revisit a Search Live response by navigating to your AI Mode history.

“Behind the scenes, Search Live in AI Mode uses a custom version of Gemini with advanced voice capabilities,” Liza Ma, the director of product management at Google Search, explained in a [blog](#) post. “Our custom model is built on Search’s best-in-class quality and information systems, so you still get reliable, helpful responses no matter where or how you’re asking your question. Search Live with voice also uses our query fan-out technique to show you a wider and more diverse set of helpful

web content, enabling new opportunities for exploration.”



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In the coming months, Google plans to bring more Live capabilities to AI Mode, including letting you ask questions based on what your phone’s camera is seeing in real time, as [was previewed at Google I/O](#) in May.

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Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter |

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporte...

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Google's AI Mode now lets users ask complex questions about images

Aisha Malik — 9:00 AM PDT · April 7, 2025

Google is bringing multimodal search to [AI Mode](#), its Google Search experiment that lets users ask complex, multi-part questions and follow-ups to dig deeper on a topic. Users who have access to AI Mode can now tap the feature to ask questions about photos they've uploaded or taken with their camera.

The new image-analyzing functionality in AI Mode is powered by Google Lens' multimodal capabilities, Google said in a blog post on Monday.

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AI Mode can understand the entire scene in an image, including how objects relate to each other, as well as their materials, colors, shapes, and arrangement, according to Google. Using a technique called “query fan-out,” AI Mode asks multiple questions about both the image and the objects shown in it, providing more detailed information than a traditional Google search.

IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

For example, you could snap a photo of your bookshelf and enter the query: “If I enjoyed these, what are some similar books that are highly rated?” AI Mode will identify each book and then provide a list of recommended books with links to learn more about and/or purchase them.

AI Mode also lets you ask follow-up questions to narrow down your search, such as “I’m looking for a

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quick read. Which one of these recommendations is the shortest?”

As part of Monday’s announcement, Google said it’s making AI Mode available to millions more users who are enrolled in [Labs](#), Google’s home for experimental features and products. Prior to this, AI Mode was only available to Google One AI Premium subscribers.

Launched last month, AI Mode looks to take on popular services like Perplexity and OpenAI’s [ChatGPT Search](#). Google has said that it plans to continue to refine the user experience and expand functionality in the feature.

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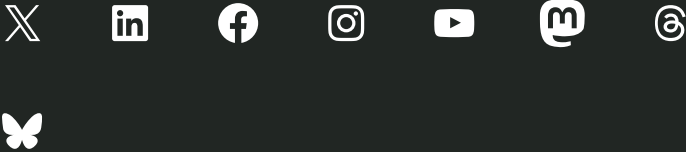
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